FAQ: Do I Need a Water Licence for My Activity or Purpose?

Question

Do I need a water licence for **[my activity/purpose]**?

Answer

Whether you need a water licence depends on **why you are using the water (your purpose of use)** and how your proposed use is classified under the **Water Sustainability Act (WSA)**.

If your activity is covered by the application guidance or another FAQ, follow that specific guidance.

If your activity or purpose is **not specifically covered**, refer to the **Water Sustainability Act (WSA)** to determine whether your proposed use requires a water licence. The Act defines the different purposes of water use and the applicable licensing requirements.

When applying, clearly describe the purpose for which the water will be used (for example, irrigation, industrial, commercial, domestic, aquaculture, or another purpose).

If you are unsure how your activity should be classified, review the Water Sustainability Act or contact FrontCounter BC for assistance before submitting your application.

Reference

Water Sustainability Act (WSA):
https://www.bclaws.gov.bc.ca/civix/document/id/complete/statreg/14015

Important

If your proposed activity is not covered by the application's guidance or FAQs, use the Water Sustainability Act to determine the appropriate purpose of use and whether a water licence is required.